

My God, My God, O Why Have You Forsaken Me?

- 1 My God, my God, O why have you
forsaken me? O why
are you so far from saving me
and from my groaning cry?
By day and night, my God, I call;
your answer still delays,
and yet you are the Holy One
who dwells in Israel's praise.
- 2 Our fathers put their trust in you;
from you salvation came.
They begged you and you set them free;
they were not put to shame.
But as for me, I am a worm
and not a man at all.
To men I am despised and base;
their scornings on me fall.
- 3 All those who look at me will laugh
and cast reproach at me.
Their mouths they open wide; they wag
their heads in mockery:
"This man has trusted in the Lord;
let God redemption send.
Now let his God deliver him,
for he delights in him."
- 4 You took me from my mother's womb
to safety at the breast.
Since birth, when I was cast on you,
you've been my God, my rest.
Be not far off, for grief is near,
and none to help is found;
for bulls of Bashan circle me,
strong bulls do me surround.
- 5 Like lion jaws they open wide,
and roar to tear their prey.
My heart is wax, my bones unknit,
my life is poured away.
My strength is dried like shattered clay;
my tongue sticks to my jaws;
you bring me to the dust of death,
and there you lay me down.
- 6 For see how dogs encircle me!
On ev'ry side there
stands a brotherhood of cruelty;
they pierce my feet and hands.
My bones are plain for me to count;
men see me and they stare.
My clothes among them they divide,
and gamble for their share.
- 7 Now hurry, O my strength, to help!
Be not far off, O Lord!
But snatch my soul from raging dogs,
and spare me from the sword.
From lion's mouth and oxen horns,
O save me; hear my prayer!
To all the church, my brethren dear,
your name I will declare.

Words: The Book of Psalms for Singing, 1973; alt.

Music: Trad. English melody; arr. Ralph Vaughan Williams, 1906

Tune: KINGSFOLD · CMD · Scripture: Psalm 22:1-22

Public domain.